Iteration A1: Creating the Product Maintenance Application

At the heart of the Depot application is a database. Getting this installed and configured and tested before proceeding will prevent a lot of headaches. If you're not certain about what you want, take the defaults, and it will go easily. If you know what you want, Rails makes it easy for you to describe your configuration.

For this project, let's make use of the Tailwind CSS[36] framework, which enables you to make pretty websites without authoring any CSS. We'll do so by specifying an additional option when we create our application, and as you'll shortly see it will also affect how we start our server during development.

Creating a Rails Application

In *Creating a New Application*, you saw how to create a new Rails application. We'll do the same thing here. Go to a command prompt and type `rails new` followed by the name of our project, and then add the option to make use of the Tailwind CSS framework. Here, our project is called `depot`, so make sure you're not inside an existing application directory, and type this:

```
work> rails new depot --css tailwind
```

We see a bunch of output scroll by. When it has finished, we find that a new directory, `depot`, has been created. That's where we'll be doing our work:

```
work> cd depot
depot> ls -p
Gemfile          app/            db/             storage/
Gemfile.lock     bin/            lib/            test/
README.md        config/         log/            tmp/
Rakefile         config.ru       public/         vendor/
```

Of course, Windows users need to use `dir /w` instead of `ls -p`.

Creating the Database